Jose Lesso

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Education

California State University, Sacramento **Sacramento, CA**
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Expected May 2028*

Technical Skills

Languages: **Java**, **Python**, **SQL**, C, C++, Bash, HTML/CSS
Frameworks & APIs: FastAPI, REST APIs
Networking & Systems: TCP/UDP sockets, HTTP/1.1, Redis (RESP2), Java concurrency, Unix processes and threads (C)
Tools: **Linux**, **Git**/GitHub, SQLite, Proxmox
Security: PortSwigger Web Security Academy (access-control labs), CompTIA Security+ (in progress)

Projects

Multi-Protocol API Gateway | *Java 21, TCP Sockets, HTTP/1.1, Redis* **Sep 2026**

- Implemented an HTTP/1.1 gateway in Java with no frameworks that, for each request, talks to 4 backend services over 4 different wire protocols (RFC 868 Time, WHOIS, Redis RESP2, and a JSON chat API)
- Enforced per-user rate limits over 60-second windows by looking up each caller's tier over WHOIS and counting requests with atomic Redis `INCR`, running both lookups concurrently and cancelling both on failure
- Hand-parsed and validated raw HTTP requests, rejecting malformed or duplicate headers and invalid Content-Length values, and returned the correct 400, 404, 405, and 429 responses

Reliable File Transfer over UDP | *Java, UDP, Sliding Window, Congestion Control* **Oct 2026**

- Implemented a Go-Back-N sliding-window sender that delivers files reliably over UDP through a proxy that delays and drops packets
- Added TCP-style congestion control (slow start, congestion avoidance, fast retransmit on the third duplicate ACK) and adaptive timeouts using Jacobson/Karels RTT estimation, Karn's algorithm, and exponential backoff

PoliScan: Conflict-of-Interest Detector | *Python, FastAPI, SQLite (Turso), Ollama* **Spring 2026**

- Developed the FastAPI backend for an Agile team tool, built for the California Fair Political Practices Commission, that flags officials who vote on agenda items tied to their own financial holdings
- Ingested Form 700 financial disclosures and Legistar API agendas and votes, and cut LLM calls by 26% by checking only the items each official voted for
- Cached every checked item and match in the database so repeat runs skip the LLM, validated results against a real FPPC enforcement case, and presented sprint demos to the client

Homelab | *Proxmox, Linux, LXC Containers, DNS* **Jun 2026**

- Installed Proxmox on a spare laptop, ran Pi-hole in an LXC container as the DNS server for home devices, and hosted an LLM agent that ran scheduled jobs and sent daily digests to Telegram

Experience

Walmart **Sep 2022 – Present**
Stocking Associate *Sacramento, CA*

- Trained new associates on stocking procedures and safety protocols
- Kept the floor running during high-traffic shifts when no team lead was present, while helping customers find products